

Positive Definite Matrix

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Positive Definite Matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} 9 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$

Eigenvalue decomposition:

$$A = \lambda_1 \mathbf{u}_1 \mathbf{u}_1^\top + \lambda_2 \mathbf{u}_2 \mathbf{u}_2^\top$$

with eigenvalues:

$$\lambda_1 = 9.47 \quad \lambda_2 = 0.53$$

and eigenvectors:

$$\mathbf{u}_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 0.97 \\ 0.23 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{u}_2 = \begin{bmatrix} -0.23 \\ 0.97 \end{bmatrix}$$

```
1 import numpy as np
2
3 A = np.array([[9, 2], [2, 1]])
4 eig_val, eig_vec = np.linalg.eig(A)
5
6 print('lambda_1 = ', eig_val[0])
7 print('lambda_2 = ', eig_val[1])
8 print('u_1 = ', eig_vec[:, 0])
9 print('u_2 = ', eig_vec[:, 1])
```

Ellipsoid

Representing positive definite matrices as ellipsoids:

$$\mathcal{E}_A = \{\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^2 \mid \mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A}^{-1} \mathbf{x} \leq 1\} \quad (\text{centered at the origin})$$

Inverse of eigenvalue decomposition:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{A} &= \lambda_1 \mathbf{u}_1 \mathbf{u}_1^\top + \lambda_2 \mathbf{u}_2 \mathbf{u}_2^\top \\ \Rightarrow \quad \mathbf{A}^{-1} &= \frac{\mathbf{u}_1 \mathbf{u}_1^\top}{\lambda_1} + \frac{\mathbf{u}_2 \mathbf{u}_2^\top}{\lambda_2} \end{aligned}$$

Geometric interpretation of $\mathcal{E}_A$:

$$\mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{A}^{-1} \mathbf{x} = \frac{(\mathbf{u}_1^\top \mathbf{x})^2}{\lambda_1} + \frac{(\mathbf{u}_2^\top \mathbf{x})^2}{\lambda_2} \leq 1 \quad \rightarrow \quad \text{ellipse!}$$

Thanks for your attention!

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